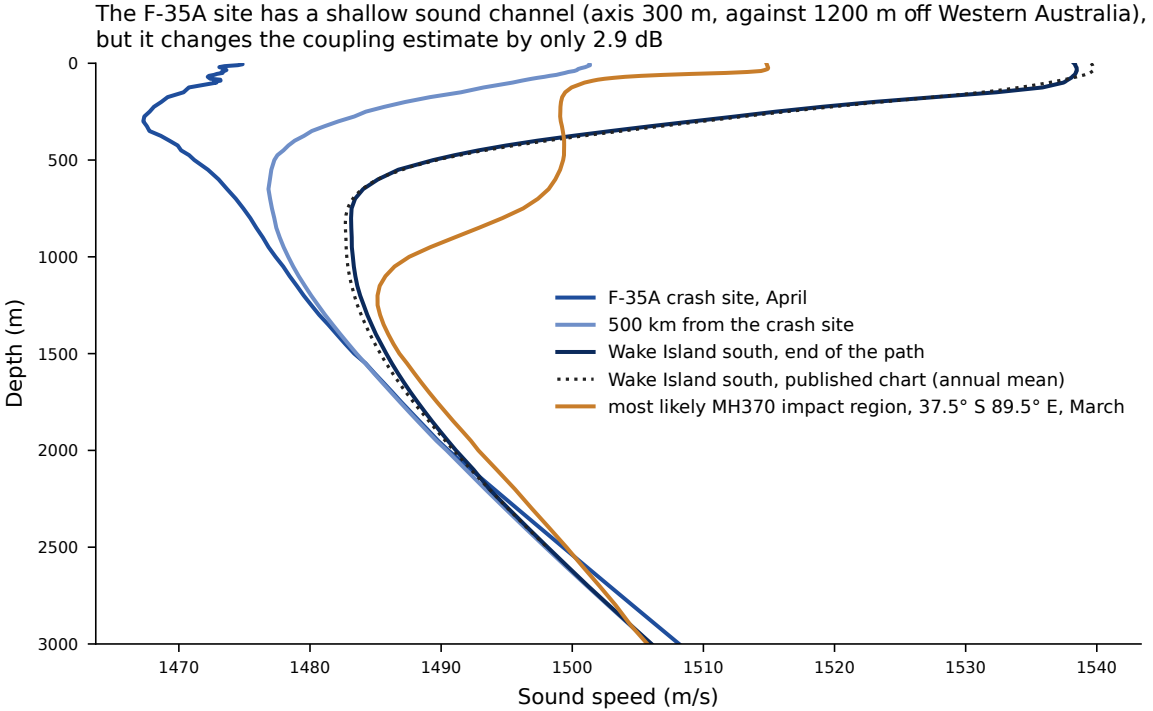

(i) The lines show how fast sound travels at each depth. At the crash site the slowest layer, where sound is trapped, is near 300 m. Near the likely MH370 area it is near 1,200 m. We changed the first 500 km of the path to the MH370 water and found the answer changed by less than a factor of two.

(ii) WOA23 B5C2 April along the F-35A -> H11S section (TL-grid builder), extended below the WOA floor as air9_tl_validation; reference = WOA23 A5B4 March at 37.5 S 89.5 E. Published H11S profile: Metz et al. Fig. 4 (WOA09 annual, Dushaw; DIGITISED). U2 (prereg 7dc315f): first 500 km of nodes replaced by the reference profile, KRAKEN, z_s 10 m: Delta = 10 log10(eta_cf/eta) = +2.9 dB -> 'upper bound because of the shallow channel' NOT SUPPORTED at the pre-registered 3 dB rule (direction as argued, size about 2x). Caveats C1 (propagation slope) and C2 (coupling not calibrated for an airliner) apply. All F-35A data DIGITISED from Metz, Obana & Fukao (2023, Pure Appl. Geophys. 180:1343).